

TRUTH IS



By Roi Werner

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Written and Directed by:
Roi Werner

Created with Kav
<https://github.com/oraboy/kav>

There was once a man
who seemed to have everything
a heart could desire.



His home was warm, his table always full,
and his name spoken kindly wherever he went.

Yet, a quiet ache stirred within him.

A man with a beard and long hair, wearing a simple white tunic, sits on a wooden chair. He is looking at a woman who is also seated. The woman has her hair in a bun and wears a green shawl over a white dress. They are in a rustic kitchen with a stone fireplace in the background, where a fire is burning. A wooden shelf above the fireplace holds various pots and a hanging pot. A window on the left shows some plants.

I am grateful
for all that I have,

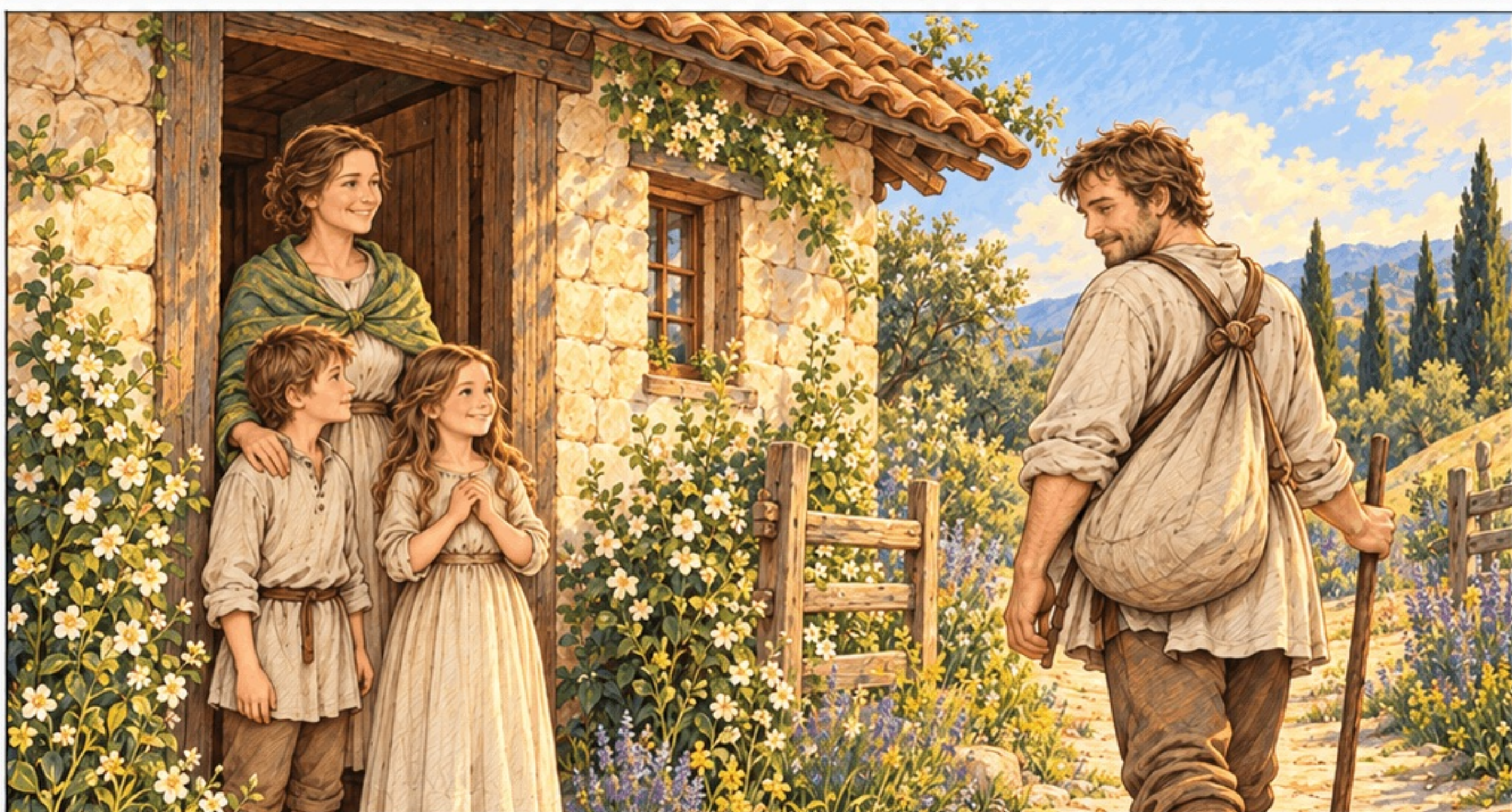
A close-up of the man's face as he speaks. He has a serious expression. The woman is visible in the background, looking at him.

but I am not at peace.
I want to know if there is more,
or is that all?

A very close-up of the man's face. He is looking slightly to the side with a thoughtful or intense expression.

I want to know Truth.





And so, with little more than
determination and a walking stick,
the man set out.



He asked after Truth in bustling towns and silent villages,
among fishers along the coast and hermits in the woods.

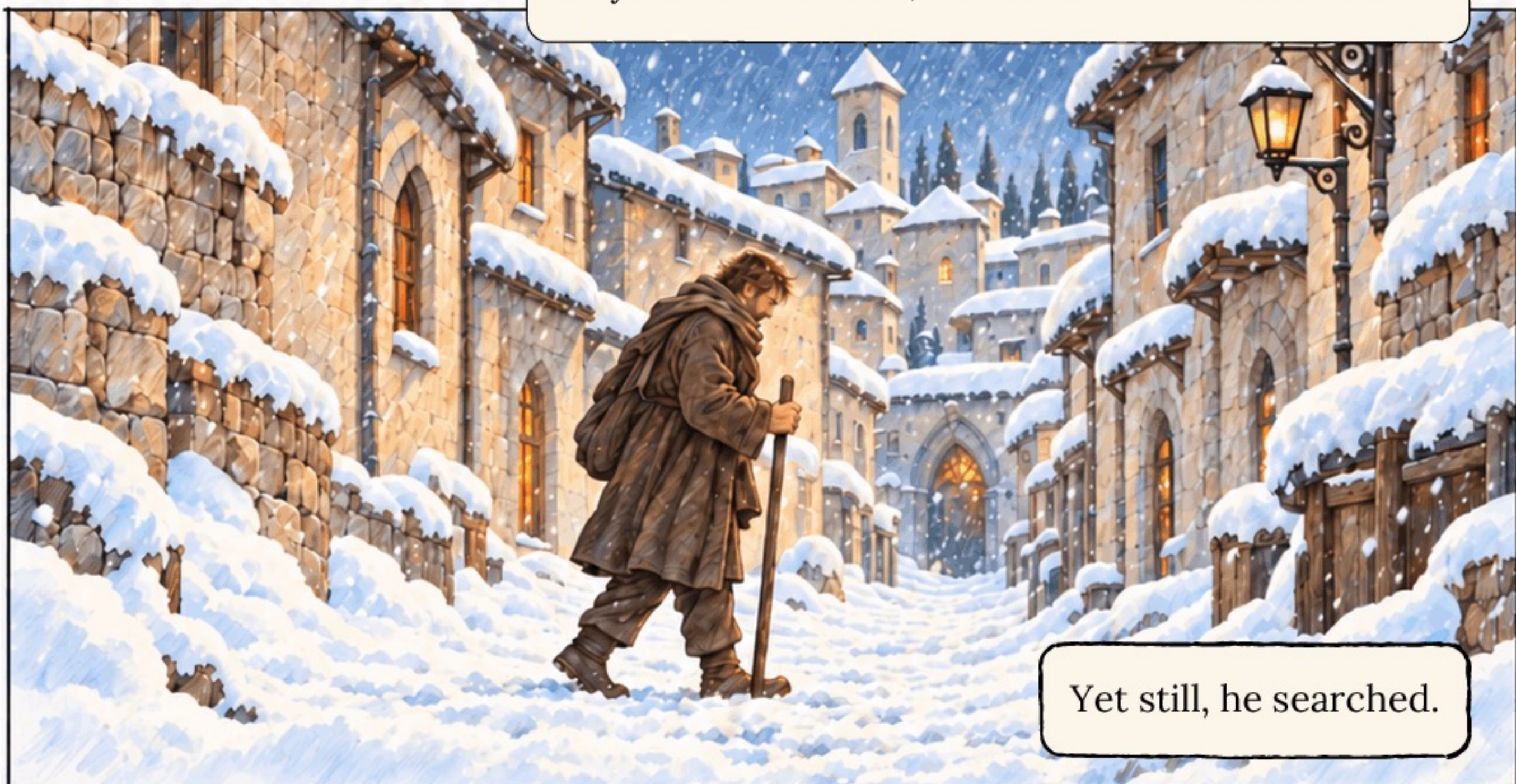




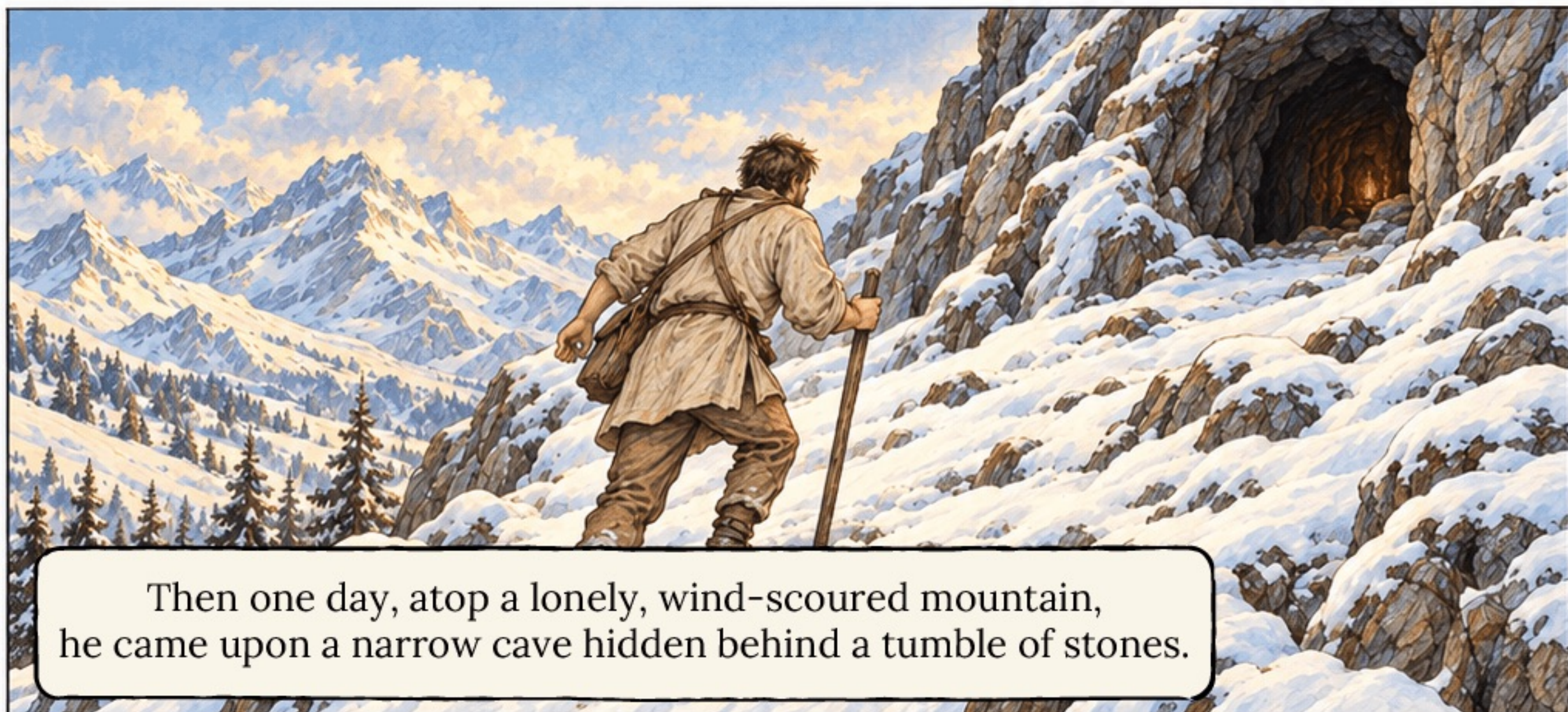
He searched through misted forests
and across meadows spangled with wildflowers,
under the scorching sun and the silver moon,
as the seasons turned like pages in a book.



Days became weeks, and weeks turned to months.



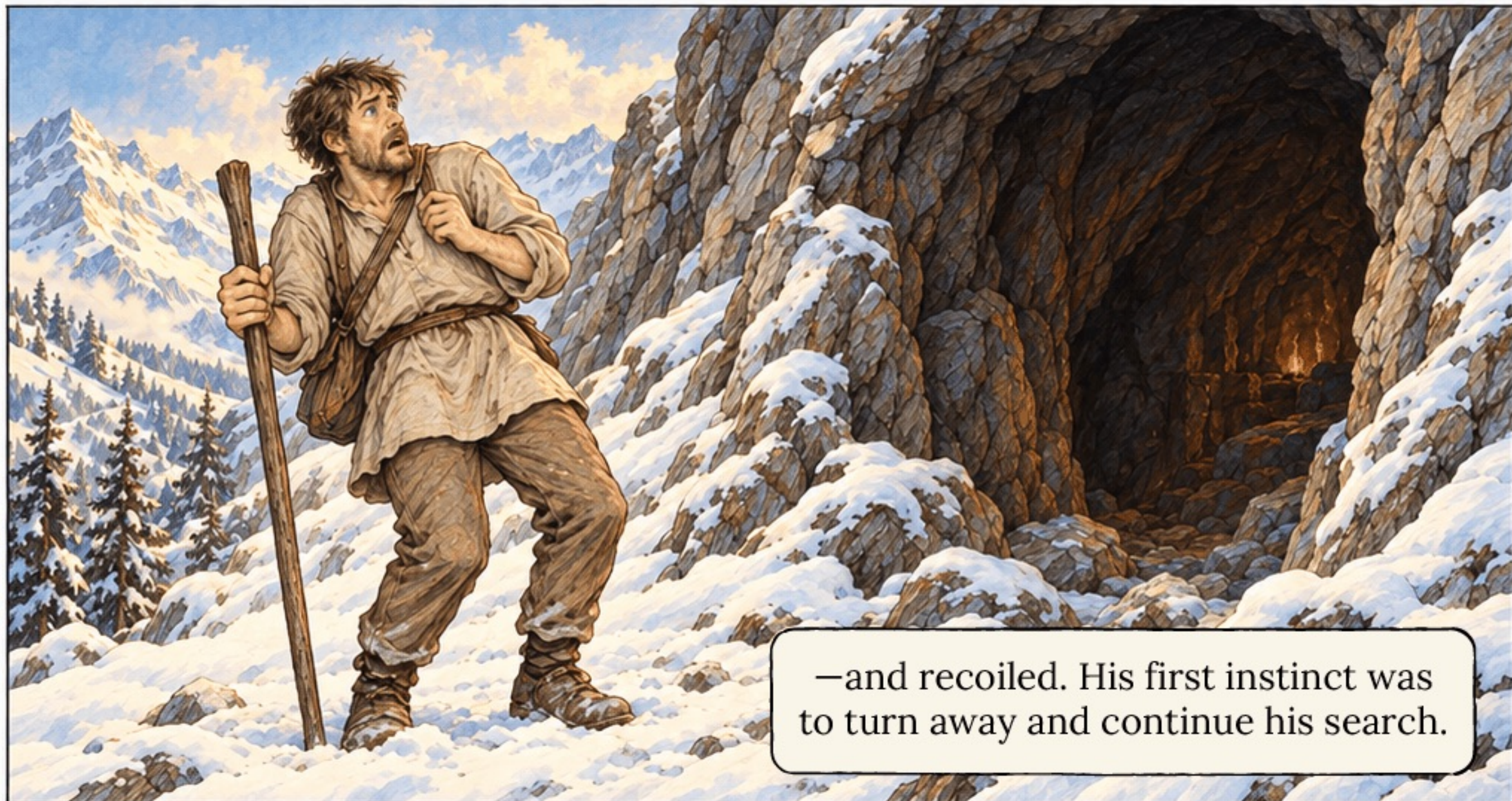
Yet still, he searched.



Then one day, atop a lonely, wind-scoured mountain, he came upon a narrow cave hidden behind a tumble of stones.



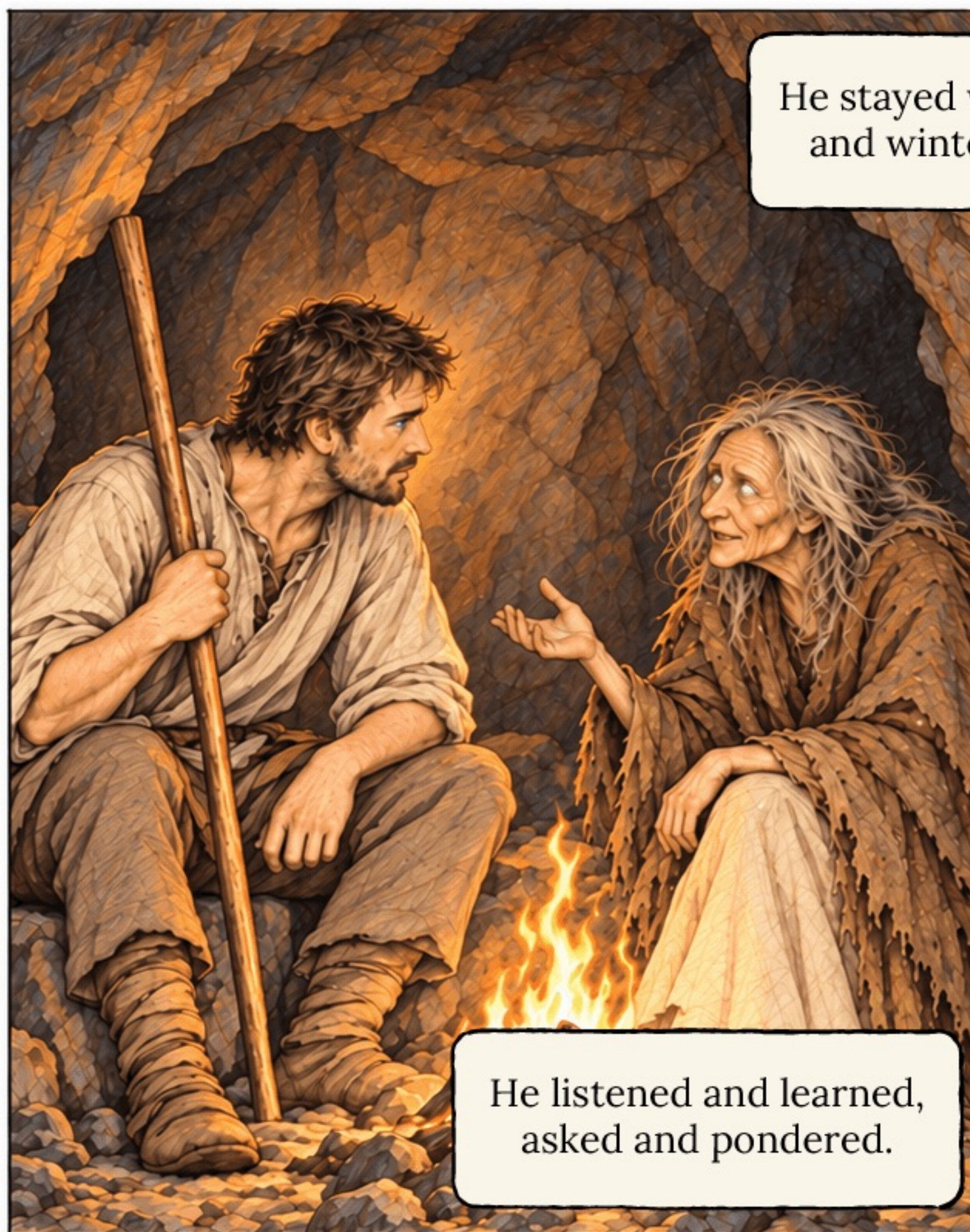
He stepped forward, peered into the gloom—



—and recoiled. His first instinct was to turn away and continue his search.

Inside, hunched in the darkness, was a withered old woman,
terrible to his eyes: stooped and wiry,
with one yellowed tooth, matted hair, and brown,
cracked skin drawn tight over sharp bones.

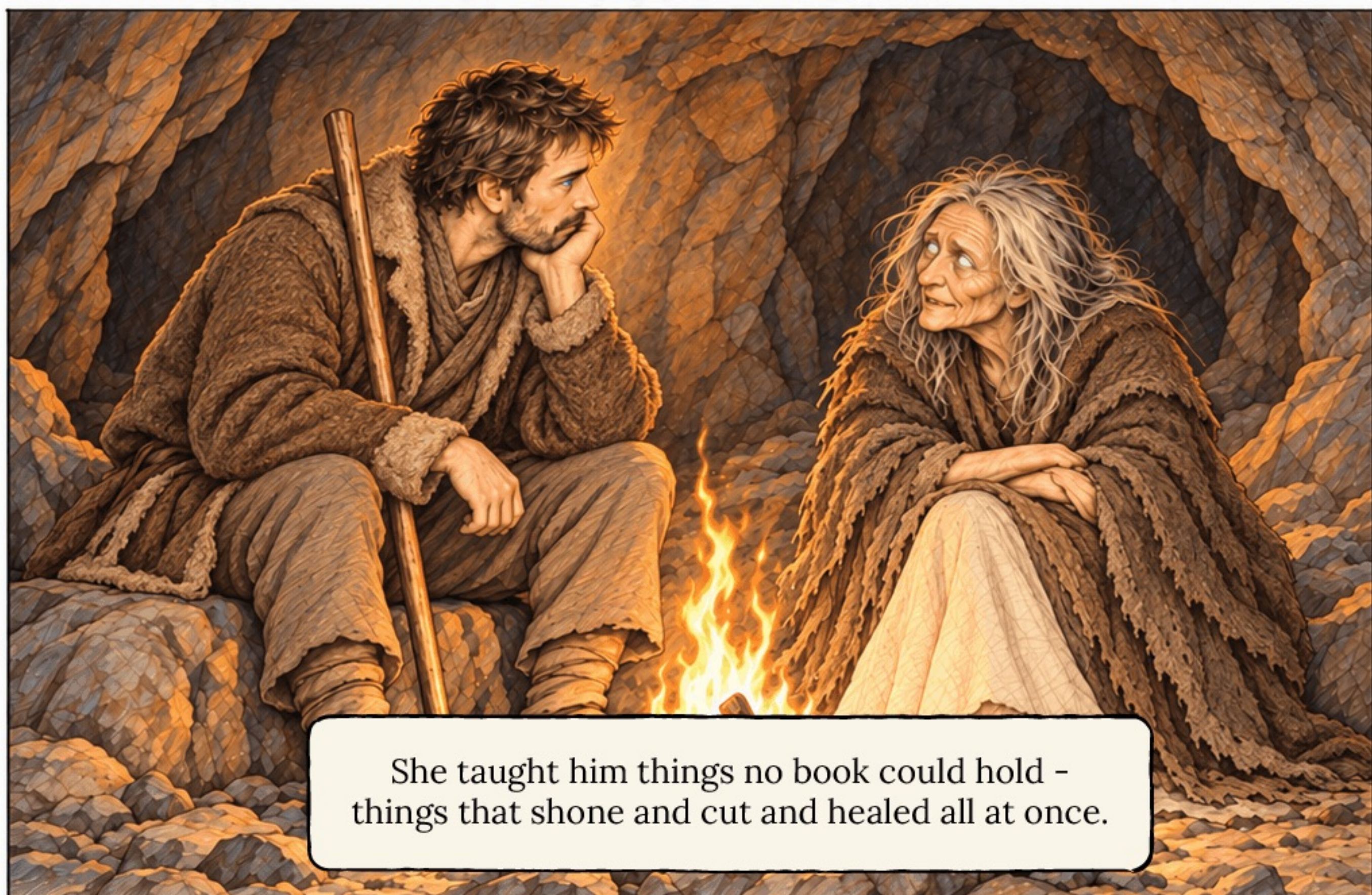




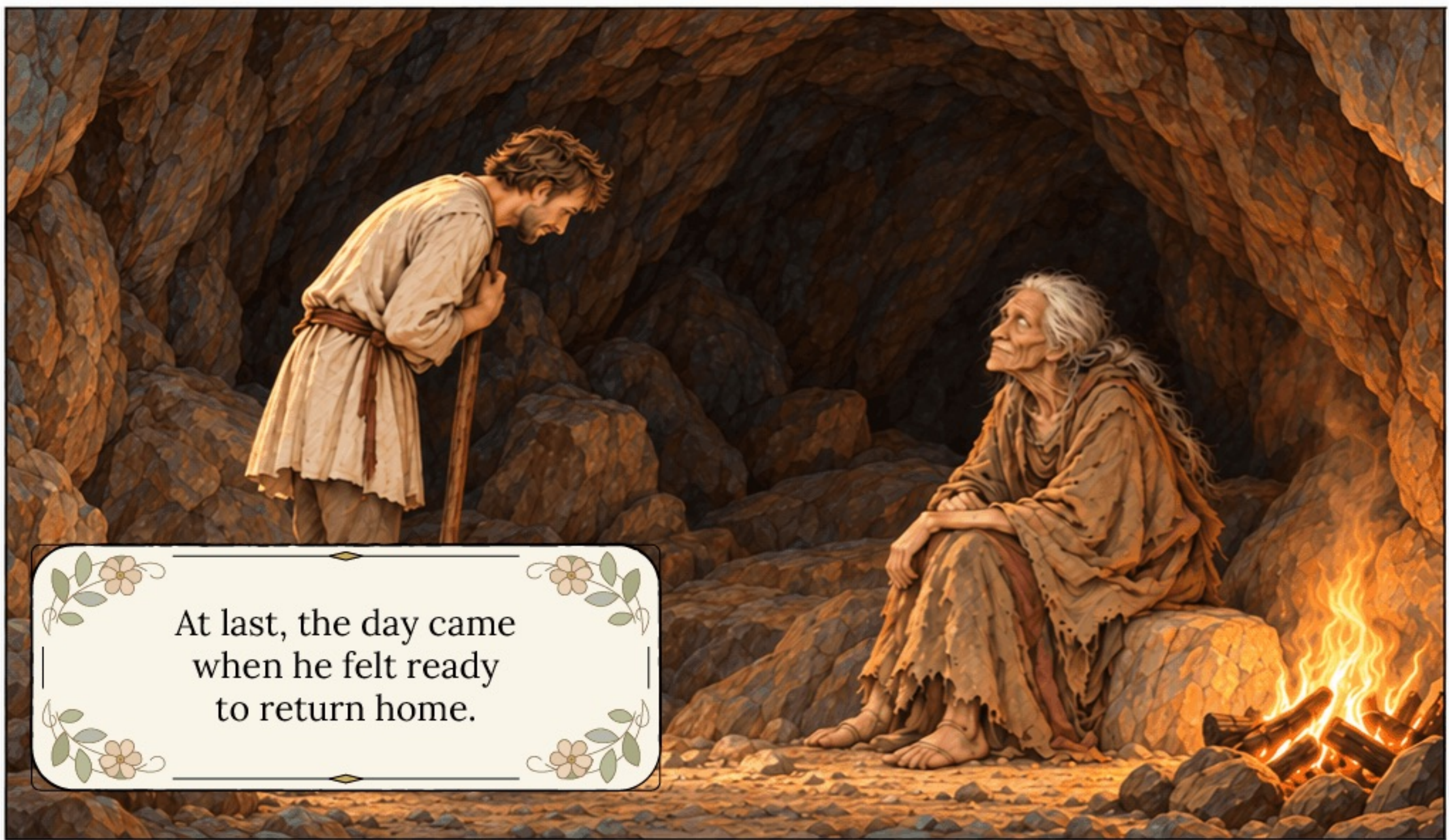
He stayed with her through summer heat
and winter snow, for a year and a day.



He listened and learned,
asked and pondered.



She taught him things no book could hold -
things that shone and cut and healed all at once.



At last, the day came
when he felt ready
to return home.



My lady Truth,
you have given me
more than I could ever repay.
Before I leave,
I wish to offer something in return.
Is there anything you desire?



Truth tilted her head and thought
for a long, quiet moment.
Then, slowly, she raised one crooked finger.



When you speak of me,
tell them I am young...
and beautiful.

Proudly Created with KAV:
<https://github.com/oraboy/kav>